COACHING MODULE

SELBORNE COLLEGE RUGBY CLUB

Module 1: **Law Changes and Coaching Tips**

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1. LAW CHANGES AND COACHING TIPS:

Experimental Law Variations

1. **Penalties**
2. **Off sides line**
3. **Ruck**
4. **Mauls**
5. **Line out**
6. **Kick offs**
7. **22m**

1. Penalties

There are now only three long arm (full) penalty offences:

1.1. Foul play
1.2. Off sides
1.3. Entering the gate incorrectly

Every other offence is a short arm (free kick).

2. Off sides line

2.1. Tackle

A tackled player now forms the offside line. It used to be when a ruck was formed. A tackled player is when either knee of the tackled player is on the ground. He must release the ball / place immediately. This becomes the offside line. Defenders must get back behind the last mans feet. A defender is put on sides when an attacking player has carried the ball for more than 5m.

There is no offside line for a defender who has tackled a player i.e. both players have a knee on the ground. There is no gate and the defender can pick the ball up and play.

2.2. Scrum

Both attacking and defending teams must be 5m from the last mans feet at the scrum. The scrum can be wheeled through to 90 degrees.

Coaching Tips:
Your fly half or first receiver needs to attack the advantage line first before executing any move. This will allow your team to take advantage of the space.
Wheeling the scrum to your advantage is something that must be considered.

2.3. Short arm

If a free kick/short arm is awarded from a ruck or maul. The defending team cannot impede the attacking player. They can be put on sides by a defender who was 10m from the offence.

Coaching Tips:
Remember that if a player goes for an up and under option he doesn't have to tap it first.
A team can slow it down by going for a scrum option. This would also be a great attacking platform for an attacking play.
Most teams will go for the quick tap, but remember to attack the linear space before the lateral space. "You must earn the right to play wide"
Players need to learn to get back and not to turn their backs on the attacking team.

3. Ruck

Hands are allowed in the ruck. Players are allowed to compete for the ball with their hands as long as they have come in from behind the gate (Spine in line with the touchline) and are on their feet. The gate is the width of the players on the ground and 45 degrees on either side.

If the attacking team can't get the ball back in 4 seconds (general interpretation) the defending team is then awarded a free kick or the choice of a scrum. The new defenders must get back 10m or they can be put on sides by a player who was 10m from the offence.

Players must roll out sideways and not through the ruck.

Coaching Tips:

Ball placement at the ruck is important, players must recoil!! Players can learn the technique by working in pairs. One player with the ball lies sideways with the other player pinning him down at the thighs. The player then swivels/recoils and places the ball with two hands. It is harder for a defender to get his hands on the ball if it is moving. This will also narrow the gate, making it harder for the defenders and easier for the attackers to enter through the gate. (The first player at the ruck must do his job i.e. clean / seal / compete etc.)

Rather hold a player up than tackle him. Players can practice fighting one another to get a grip under the arms. Palms in and force out.

'Breaststroke' cleaning out technique can be used to get the arms away (palms in). Remember 'hooks and handles'.

If a team is not dominating in this area they may want to avoid setting up a ruck i.e. keep the ball off the ground.

Cleaning out has now become even more important than ever. Something to consider is the fact that more time is spent at the ruck than anywhere else during a game. It is therefore vital that a lot of time is spent on rucking during training.

4. Mauls

Collapsing of the maul is now allowed. Players can only collapse from waist to shoulder height, provided that they were part of the initial maul. A player joining a maul is not allowed to collapse it.

Truck and trailer is allowed from a maul.

2 attackers bound with the ball (held up) and 1 defender constitutes a maul. The last man's feet on both sides are the off side lines.

5. Line out

There are no longer numbers in the line out. There is just a minimum of 2 players. There has to be a designated scrumhalf who must be 2m from the lineout. There doesn't have to be a hooker anymore and he is not allowed to lift from inside the 5m.

You can use a quick throw in and it doesn't have to be a straight throw (it can be passed backwards). If a spectator has touched it, you cannot take it quickly.

Coaching Tip:
No numbers in the line out will have to make us think carefully about our short line out options.
If the opposition go with a short line out, we should always consider putting 6 players in i.e. 2 jumping pods. Remember the players at the back of the line out can apply more pressure on their attacking line because they are closer than the other defenders who are 10m behind them.
If a quick throw has been taken there is no off side line.

6. Kick offs

If you kick it out directly the following options are given to the team receiving: Short arm in the middle of the field / Scrum in the middle / Line out on the halfway.

If it has been a 22m drop out and the ball goes directly into touch. The free kick can be taken anywhere along the 22m.

7. 22m

If the ball is passed back into the 22m it cannot be kicked out directly. If it is, the line out will take place from where the player kicked it from. A phase must be set up first before it can be kicked out i.e. tackle/ruck/maul.

Coaching Tips:

When taking the ball up:

1. Use your feet to beat the defender
2. Look for the offload before contact
3. Look for the offload in contact
4. Look for the offload when tackled i.e. on the ground

Getting a break:
If a player has made a line break he should not kick it away. A kick will put all the defenders on sides.

Team selection:
Your scrumhalf may have to be replaced by a stronger player (centre) and the fullback will need to have a strong upper body (loose forward). By picking a stronger fullback it will enable the player to hold the attacking player up. Remember once the attacker has put a knee on the ground the off sides line is created. It might be a better option to not create the off sides line by holding him up. This will give time for your defenders to get back.

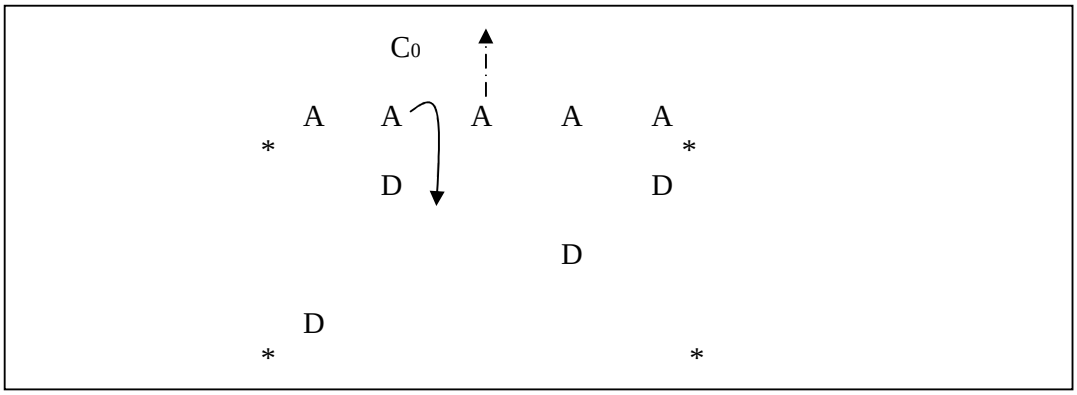
Tactic off the scrum:
One needs to exploit the 5m rule from the scrum. An idea would be to replace the 8 with 9. 9 picks up, attacks the advantage line and puts 8 away. If 8 is tackled there is a new offside line i.e. the defenders in the scrum are offside.

Your first receiver from the scrum should be the most explosive player that you have e.g. your wing, so you can exploit the 10m gap.

Fitness and conditioning:
The players have to be extremely fit and a lot of work needs to be done on upper body and core strength.

Adapted touch rugby games:
The old ‘one-touch’ has become obsolete. ‘Six-touch’ with off loading needs to be introduced etc.

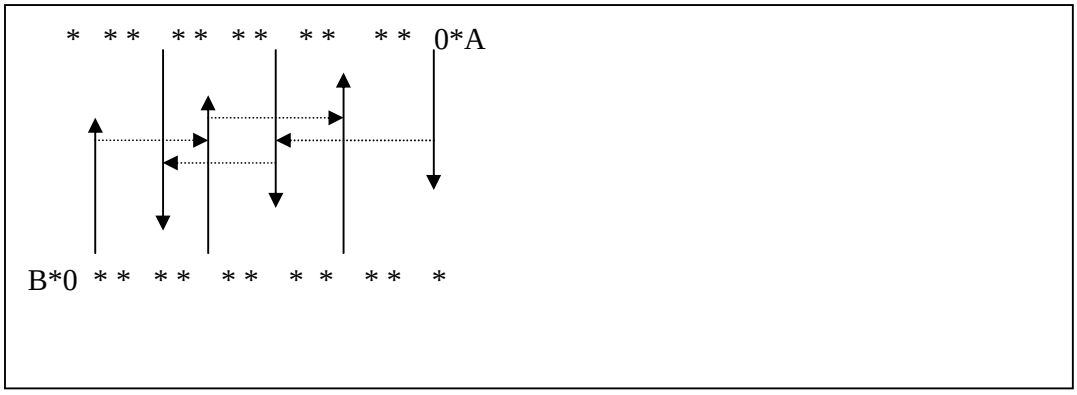
Attacking Drill:



The attacking players face the coach with their backs to the defenders. The defenders position themselves in the attacking area. The coach passes to any attacker which is the signal for the attacking sequence to begin.
This drill teaches the attacking players to exploit the space that is in front of them (simulating an attack in broken play).

Coaching Tip:
Players need to learn how to play it the way they see it. Any drills that work on this skill will benefit them.

Passing Drill:



Team A and B must stay in their channels. Both teams start at the same time. A1 and B1 both have a ball. Once they have run past the respective B3 / A3 player they pass behind them to player A2 / B2 respectively, who then repeat the same thing. A variation to this drill is to pass before the respective player has run past (this is a higher grade exercise).